



PROGRESS REPORT

Malawi: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 182 systems and instruments tracked

Of 182 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 64 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-26, 31 did not, 30 carry no stated baseline, and 57 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 122 sources for this place in the window — 21 in the earlier half (2025-09 to 2026-02), 101 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Over the twelve months to 6 August 2026 Malawi's identity register advanced and its governing instruments did not. Adult identity coverage rose from 12.5 million in May 2025 to more than 13.5 million ([registration bureau](#)). Public procurement went from voluntary to mandatory for all public entities on 1 April 2026 ([procurement authority](#)). Mobile money transaction value rose 94% to MWK 37.9tn ([central bank report](#)).

Against those, the Data Protection Act's twenty-four-month exemption elapsed in early June 2026 with no subsidiary instrument made and no enforcement action of any kind on record ([draft regulations](#)); the service bus did not enter service; and a national artificial intelligence strategy, a national digital transformation strategy, a local-authority ICT policy and a government data-sharing regulation all ended the period in draft.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Draft National Artificial Intelligence Strategy	Did not exist; regional consultative workshops to develop Malawi's first National AI Strategy were launched in September 2025, after the window opened	A draft has been through a two-day validation workshop in Lilongwe and a citizen-feedback portal, and a UNESCO readiness assessment report was validated on 2026-07-22 to guide it; the strategy is pre-adoption, with no adoption date on record	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Draft National Digital Transformation Strategy	Did not exist; regional consultative workshops to develop it began in September 2025 alongside the AI strategy	A draft is in validation and pre-adoption, intended to align with the national development vision and the national digitisation policy; no adoption date is on record at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
Presidential directive on digitalisation of public services	Did not exist as a directive at 2025-08-01	The President directed all ministries, departments and agencies to digitalise passports, national ID cards, driver's licences and public procurement forthwith, against a target of 80% internet usage by 2026; no baseline is given against which that target could be assessed	ADVANCED
Malawi Digitalisation Policy 2023-28	Adopted and in force, with government services still siloed: the service bus intended to let ministries exchange data was not operational through 2025, leaving passport registration and driver's licence payments unavailable online	Still in force and still the reference framework, with the e-government department under pressure to onboard all ministries, departments and agencies onto the service bus; an industry association set a mid-2026 expectation that driver's licence renewals and national ID applications would be fully online, and nothing on file records that being met	NO CHANGE
Relief on the internet surtax and smartphone value-added tax	Did not exist	The ICT minister called for scrapping the 10% surtax on internet services and reviewing the 17.5% value-added tax on smartphones to make digital access affordable, setting a target of raising mobile internet usage from 12.5% to at least 30% by 2030. No budget measure, bill or instrument is on record	BASELINE NOT HELD

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AI Bill	Did not exist; no artificial-intelligence statute or bill appears in the base at 2025-08-01	Announced as the statutory backing for the National AI Strategy, to establish a regulatory framework promoting innovation while safeguarding citizen privacy and ensuring operational accountability; the ICT minister put the target for reaching parliament at before December 2026, with the strategy to ground the law, and restated the intention to legislate in August 2026. No draft text is stated and the strategy own text is not held	ADVANCED
Data Protection Act 2024	In force since 2024-06-03, with the regulator designated data protection authority; the statute exempted controllers and processors not of significant importance from compliance for 24 months from commencement, so most of the economy was outside the Act's obligations	In force, with the general exemption elapsed in early June 2026 so that all controllers and processors are within scope; subsidiary instruments to operate registration and enforcement were still in draft at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED, GRACE PERIOD ELAPSED
Financial Crimes (Amendment) Bill No. 19 of 2026	Did not exist; the base carries no bill or amendment on cheques or bearer negotiable instruments at 2025-08-01	Passed by Parliament removing all references to cheques and bearer negotiable instruments from the principal Act, as one of four bills passed together: amendments to the Financial Crimes, Payment Systems and Deposit Insurance Corporation Acts following the Bills of Exchange (Amendment) Bill that effects the cheque phase-out. Assent, gazette date and commencement are not published, and the safeguarding regulations the finance minister promised are not drafted	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Government Data Sharing Regulation	Did not exist; the national data-exchange platform operated without binding rules and ministries, departments and agencies shared citizen data by email, USB drive and paper	A proposed regulation would route all data requests through the national data centre, require encryption in transit and at rest, set a common digital standard for system-to-system exchange, and require binding data sharing agreements with usage limits and audit trails; it is not made, and no draft text is held	ADVANCED
Review of the National Registration Act	The base carries no statement on the Act's status or on any review of it	An acceleration-project consultative meeting has reviewed the National Registration Act and the marriage and family relations statute, with the registration bureau stating the aim is to support a modern and secure civil registration and identification system; no bill, draft or timetable is on record	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Authority within the regulator	Designated under the Act but not stood up; the government was tendering advisory and technical consultancy to produce the unit's organogram and governance charter, staffing, operations manual, monitoring and enforcement framework, and a business plan targeting cost recovery within five years	Operating as a unit inside the regulator with a named head of data protection and a stated implementation framework; no organogram, enforcement record or registration data is published	ADVANCED
Draft Data Protection Regulations, Guidelines and Registration Fees	No subsidiary data-protection instruments were made; drafting of regulations, codes of practice, guidelines, a priced service list and a scale of fines was still out to tender under an acceleration-project consultancy in October 2025	The regulator has published draft regulations, guidelines and a turnover-based registration fee schedule ranging from MWK 50,000 for small and medium enterprises to MWK 7 million for the largest controllers and processors of significant importance, and consulted stakeholders before finalisation; no commencement date is on record	ADVANCED
Separation of the data protection authority and the emergency response team from the regulator	Both bodies sat inside the regulator under the Data Protection Act; no separation plan is on record	The regulator states it intends to establish both as independent institutions, with World Bank technical assistance and capacity building; no legislative vehicle, timetable or funding model is on record	ADVANCED

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Ghana digital-government cooperation	Did not exist	A Malawian delegation travelled to Accra to structure a digital-government cooperation with Ghana's communications ministry, under which Ghana is to make more than a dozen technology companies available to help build digital systems and infrastructure; Ghana's identity card is cited as the reference implementation at more than 19 million holders, and Malawi brings a high-coverage national identity system, a data centre and a government data exchange platform	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Lilongwe Declaration on Collaborative Regulation	Did not exist	Adopted; anchors to the international regulatory maturity framework, sets six shared principles and seven areas of collaborative action, and treats artificial intelligence, satellite, digital platforms and next-generation networks as one emerging-technology frontier	ADVANCED
COMESA regional AI investment priorities	Baseline not held	Proposed: agriculture, healthcare, climate resilience, education, financial services and regional trade named as AI investment priorities for the bloc	BASELINE NOT HELD
Regulator collaboration with UNDP on AI, digital identity and data protection	The base carries no statement of a regulator position on artificial intelligence or digital identity	Exploratory, with priorities named as national identity integration with SIM verification, responsible artificial intelligence, stronger data protection and secondary-school digital skills drawing on the universal service fund; no memorandum, funding figure or timetable is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD
SADC Regional AI Strategy and Regulatory Framework	The base carries no position on a regional AI framework at 2025-08-01	Under development, not adopted or published; no draft, adoption date or document title beyond the name	BASELINE NOT HELD

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Copyright society rule on wholly AI-generated works	Did not exist; no rule on the registration of, or royalties for, AI-generated works is on record	The statutory copyright body will not register works created entirely by artificial intelligence or distribute royalties on them; the rule is known only as reported, with no test stated for how much AI assistance is admissible	ADVANCED
Blank media levy distribution methodology	No position held at 2025-08-01	Distribution rests entirely on records submitted by licensed disc-burning centres of songs customers ask to have copied, not on digital consumption; of roughly MWK 3bn collected in 2026, about MWK 1.44bn, some 48%, reaches rights holders, and tax reconciliation against a rights holder's taxpayer number is not automatic	BASELINE NOT HELD

The governing position for personal data changed in scope without changing in enforcement. At the start of the period the Data Protection Act 2024 had been in force for fourteen months with its exemption still running and no subsidiary instrument made; in October 2025 the government was tendering consultancy to design the authority's structure and enforcement framework ([terms of reference](#)). By July 2026 the exemption had elapsed, a head of data protection had been named, and draft regulations with a turnover-based fee schedule were out to consultation ([consultation account](#)). No fine, order, breach notification, complaint or prosecution under the Act appears in the base at either end of the period.

The rest of the section began the period as nothing and ended it as drafts. Both national strategies did not exist at the start; workshops began in September 2025 and both entered validation in February 2026, neither adopted. A government data-sharing regulation was proposed in June 2026 and not made ([ministry account](#)).

Two positions did not move at all. The electoral commission's refusal of machine-readable access to the voter roll, made in June 2025, stands unchanged through the September 2025 elections and after. And the competition authority's July 2025 order requiring a mobile-money operator to open its exclusive e-ticketing platform to other providers within a year reached its deadline in July 2026 with nothing on file recording compliance.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Device assembly allocation to the science and technology university	The base carries no prior-year figure	MWK 1.1bn allocated for assembling laptops and tablets at the Malawi University of Science and Technology - the nearest digital allocation to schools in that budget, and directed at higher education	BASELINE NOT HELD
National Birth Registration Campaign appropriation	The base carries no statement of the campaign's cost or funding before 2025-08-01	The campaign requires MWK 17.8bn in total to register about 4.6 million children across seven phases in 25 districts; MWK 5.4bn was allocated in the 2025/26 financial year for phases 1 and 2, leaving MWK 12.4bn unfunded	BASELINE NOT HELD
School connectivity line in the 2026/27 national budget	The base carries no statement about school-connectivity appropriation before 2025-08-01	The 2026/27 budget policy statement contains no dedicated line for school internet connectivity or digital infrastructure in primary and secondary schools; education received MWK 1.28tn, 11.7% of the budget, directed at fee abolition, classrooms, teaching materials and university operations, and transport and ICT received MWK 664.4bn directed at roads, rail and aviation	BASELINE NOT HELD

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Vendor investment memorandum	The base carries no proposal, negotiation or announcement before 2025-08-01	A proposed US\$180m over four years, built round a one-stop digital government platform and a high-speed network linking all 28 districts with ring protection; funding structure, implementation timeline and any agreements reached have not been made public	BASELINE NOT HELD

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Governance to Enable Service Delivery Project	Operating, paying performance-based grants to participating district councils	Closed on 2026-06-30; its grant mechanism continues under the successor project	CLOSED
Inclusive Digital Transformation for Malawi	Running 2024-2028 on a European Union commitment of EUR 2,000,000 and a UNDP commitment of US\$5,608,640, covering inclusive digital identity, open-source public systems with human-rights safeguards, and youth digital literacy; the Union separately reported contributing over EUR 10m to the national registration system that underpins it	Unchanged in commitment; within the window the programme's policy strand reached a validation workshop in Lilongwe for a draft national digital transformation strategy and a draft national AI strategy, both still pre-adoption	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Malawi Fiscal Governance Program-for-Results	An approved grant of SDR 60.3m, about US\$80m equivalent at appraisal, supporting revenue mobilisation, budget execution and procurement modernisation, including e-procurement digitalisation	Unchanged; the base carries no implementation, disbursement or results reporting after the appraisal document	NO CHANGE
Support for Digitalization, Financial Inclusion and Competitiveness	An active institutional-support grant of XDR 10,000,000, recorded as approximately US\$14.4m on an unstated conversion, with US\$5,591,335 disbursed as at the record's retrieval date	Unchanged; no event in the window is on file for this project	NO CHANGE

Parliament ratified an SDR 58.2m grant for local-government service delivery on 29 July 2026, extending coverage to 32 councils from the predecessor's 28 and funding business-process re-engineering ahead of equipment purchase ([parliamentary approval](#)).

The 2026/27 national budget carries no dedicated line for school connectivity ([landscape analysis](#)).

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Additional mobile operator licensing round	Did not exist; no proposal for a new licensing round appears in the base at 2025-08-01	The ICT minister told Parliament that additional operator licences were under consideration, and that the President had authorised the ministry to identify an investor able to roll out a network without delay; no bid timetable, licence terms or spectrum allocation is stated. The minister conceded that foreign-exchange shortages constrain incumbents' equipment imports and that earlier licensees who took spectrum without launching had licences revoked, ending in litigation	ADVANCED
Airtel Malawi satellite connectivity plan	Did not exist; no operator satellite position appears in the base at 2025-08-01	Interest signalled in satellite connectivity to complement terrestrial networks in hard-to-reach areas and improve resilience; no partner, licence, capital allocation or timetable is stated	ADVANCED
Communication tower programme	Did not exist as a named line; the acceleration project appraisal itemises component allocations and carries no tower-infrastructure line, the nearest being rural connectivity at US\$20m	The regulator advancing procurement for more than 90 towers, with the project stated as committed to around 100; a study cited at the same meeting puts the requirement for nationwide coverage above 1,000 towers. No contract award, site list or completion date is on record	ADVANCED
Converged Technology Networks fixed-wireless network	<i>Baseline not held</i>	4G LTE fixed-wireless coverage extended to Areas 9, 25 and 36, Airwing and Chitipi, taking the network to nineteen named neighbourhoods across the capital, with free long-term connectivity for more than twenty secondary schools under a partnership with unconnected.org and the Internet Society	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital Malawi Acceleration Project	Approved 2024-06-27 and launched November 2024 at a total operation cost of US\$90.00m, a US\$70.00m grant plus US\$20.00m unguaranteed commercial financing, with targets of 2,000 schools, 500 further government offices, digital ID enrolment and an affordable-devices programme; no delivery recorded	Procurement of service providers for more than 90 towers being advanced, the national data centre being upgraded to an AI-ready state, and 25 e-services being onboarded to the data-exchange platform	ADVANCED
Four-year ICT investment plan	Did not exist; no such investment plan appears in the base at 2025-08-01	A proposed US\$180m four-year plan built round two projects: a one-stop digital government platform covering passport applications, business registration and tax payments; and a high-speed network linking all 28 districts with ring protection against cable failures. Funding structure, implementation timeline and any agreements reached have not been made public	ADVANCED
Harmonised national broadband mapping	Did not exist	The regulator hosted a five-day intermediate GIS and data-management training at Lilongwe for broadband-mapping practitioners from Malawi, Zimbabwe, Botswana and Zambia, under a 2025-2028 project to establish or strengthen harmonised national broadband mapping systems in eleven sub-Saharan regulators, supported by the European Union	ADVANCED
Malcel licence	Licensed as Malawi's intended third major mobile operator, targeting a late-2023 commercial launch, delayed by macroeconomic conditions, with no new date announced	Unchanged at 2026-07-20; still no commercial launch and no announced date	STALLED
Satellite connectivity for rural schools	Did not exist as a deployment; at 2025-08-01 the base records only that technical assistance had prepared the regulator to enable low-earth-orbit satellite services	30 rural schools connected, reported as serving 100,000 students and 1,500 teachers (company-announced); responsibility for the recurring subscription cost is not stated	ADVANCED
Tariff-notice requirement under the Communications Act 2016	In force, requiring approved tariff changes to be published in at least two daily newspapers seven days before taking effect; the base holds no record of enforcement	The regulator found both mobile operators in breach in respect of the 26 June to 2 July 2026 notice window, and both agreed to credit affected customers with bundles equal to the price difference by 2026-07-31 with evidence of compliance, alongside strengthened internal compliance procedures; the approved price increase itself stands	ADVANCED
Access Communications licence	Licensed 2007, holding a small share of mobile subscribers and available mainly in major cities	Unchanged at 2026-07-20; has not significantly challenged the two-operator duopoly	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Last Mile Connectivity and National Data Centre loan	A China Construction Bank commercial loan covering 136 tower installations and last-mile fibre, with the first tower launched at Mbvunguti Village on 2020-06-13 and 28 towers expected in the then-current phase	Unchanged; no progress report, disbursement figure or completion statement is held, and no account of how this project relates to the Lilongwe data centre built under the World Bank project	NO CHANGE
Malawi Digital Foundations Project	Closed since October 2024; US\$72.4m committed and US\$72.6m disbursed, having delivered the Lilongwe national data centre, the national data-exchange platform and the first phase of e-procurement, connected some 640 government sites against a target of 400, and over 100 free public Wi-Fi spots	Unchanged; the base holds no post-closure evaluation and no independent verification of the reported results, which are the lender's own	NO CHANGE
National Fibre Backbone Project, Phases I and II	Phase I financed by a China Eximbank government concessional loan of CNY 155,432,330, committed 2016 and running 2017 to 2018, recorded as closed. Phase II financed by a concessional loan of CNY 693,000,000 at 1% over 20 years, committed 2020 with start year 2021, on-lent to the electricity utility, with CNY 299,286,770 drawn as at June 2023 and first repayment falling due 2027-03-21	Unchanged; the base holds the two loan records and no statement of route kilometres, completion, operator or current operating status	NO CHANGE
Nyasa Mobile licence	Licensed in 2022, with operational delays attributed to economic conditions and no commercial launch date announced	Unchanged at 2026-07-20	NO CHANGE
Spectrum licence fee reduction	A 20% reduction in radio-frequency spectrum licence fees across all bands, announced following review of the regulator's 2016 incentive pricing model; no fee schedule, gazette notice or statutory instrument is held, so the base amounts and the date the reduced fees took effect are unknown	Unchanged. On 2026-07-17 the ICT minister told Parliament the reduction was 50%; the base treats that as a misstatement of the 2025 measure, since five contemporaneous accounts of the regulator's own announcement say 20% and no source records a second reduction	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
TNM 5G network	Launched at the international conference centre in Lilongwe with a vendor as technical partner, the first 5G network in Malawi, with coverage stated only for Lilongwe and four further cities named as extension targets	Unchanged; the base holds no later site count or coverage figure	NO CHANGE
Wholesale international bandwidth price	Fell from about US\$460 per Mbit/s per month at project start in 2017 to below US\$10 at close in 2024	Unchanged; the base holds no wholesale price for 2025 or 2026, so whether the gain has held is not established	NO CHANGE
Airtel Malawi 5G sites in service	No figure held at 2025-08-01	111 sites across 10 districts (company-reported), after 58 new sites added on MWK 50.8bn of network capital expenditure in the 2025 financial year	BASELINE NOT HELD
Incumbent mobile operator network investment	Not held	US\$31m stated by the second mobile operator as invested to expand network capacity and coverage nationally, to meet growing voice and data demand	BASELINE NOT HELD
Mobile and internet subscriber and coverage series	Baseline not held	An industry association report puts fourth-generation coverage at 87% of the population against mobile-internet penetration of 12.5%, with mobile-money adoption described as near universal; the same report scores Malawi 36 of 100 on its digital nations and society index and 55 of 100 on policy and regulation	BASELINE NOT HELD
Schools with limited or no internet access	No school-connectivity figure held at 2025-08-01	85% of Malawi's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none, with lack of electricity and of digital devices named as the main barriers; the 2026/27 national budget carries no dedicated line for school internet connectivity, the World Bank is separately supporting connection of over 200 schools, and the acceleration project targets 2,000	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Boma Lathu National Data Exchange Platform	Delivered as a data-exchange platform under the foundations project alongside a new national data centre; government institutions still shared citizen data by email, USB and paper	In use by the revenue authority and the registration bureau, hosted on locally managed servers, with 25 e-services being onboarded and the immigration department integrating while retaining data ownership	ADVANCED
Commercial data centre, Lilongwe	Did not exist; commercial local hosting capacity is not recorded in the base at 2025-08-01	In operation offering commercial local hosting, positioned against the foreign-currency cost and data-ownership exposure of offshore hosting and welcomed by the e-government department; capacity, tier and pricing not stated	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Data Centre, Lilongwe	Built in Lilongwe under the foundations project on a hyper-converged design, serving as the primary data centre with Blantyre as secondary and backup; reported at 51% complete in March 2024 with completion expected May 2024, and recorded as delivered at project close	Operating as the local-hosting base for the national data-exchange platform, used by the revenue authority and the registration bureau with 25 e-services being onboarded, and undergoing upgrade to an AI-ready state under the acceleration project; the proposed data-sharing regulation would route all government data requests through it	ADVANCED
TNM third data centre	Did not exist; no third data centre appears in the base at 2025-08-01	Announced by the chief executive in Lilongwe alongside a voice-over-LTE launch, for construction within the following three months. That period ended in June 2026 and the base holds no record of a start, a site or a completion at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED, STATED TARGET PASSED
Revenue authority secondary data centre	Not held	In service with uninterruptible power supply upgrades, reported as improving service continuity, cutting queues and improving customs-duty accuracy on the customs system at border posts and the international airport, financed by the World Bank under a six-year, US\$150m regional trade and connectivity project running to 2027	BASELINE NOT HELD
Share of web content served from within Malawi	No figure held at 2025-08-01	3% of content served locally and 62% served regionally, primarily from South Africa - the lowest local share among the economies in the study	BASELINE NOT HELD

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Solar-powered coverage extension	Did not exist; no solar or off-grid network-power position appears in the base at 2025-08-01	The chief executive stated the operator covers 85% of the population and is working to reach the remaining 15% through cost-effective technologies including solar-powered infrastructure; no site count, capital allocation, target date or partner is stated, and foreign-exchange shortages were named as the operator's biggest challenge	ADVANCED
Electricity tariff increase cited in the 2026 operator tariff applications	No electricity price figure held at 2025-08-01	An 8% rise in electricity tariffs, alongside a roughly 144% rise in fuel prices, cited by both mobile operators in support of an average 55% tariff increase application; the regulator approved 22.2% for one and 26% for the other	BASELINE NOT HELD

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Artificial intelligence laboratories and innovation hubs	Did not exist; no operator AI laboratory or innovation hub appears in the base at 2025-08-01	Announced by the chief executive for establishment in 2026, to let Malawians build AI-driven services; no site, budget, partner or opening date is stated, and nothing on record shows one has opened at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
Malawi Research and Education Network	Over 83,000 students across 81 institutions gained cheaper connectivity through the network under the foundations project	Unchanged; the base holds no institutional membership, bandwidth, governance or funding position after project close, and the acceleration project's school and office targets are not described as running through it	NO CHANGE

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Payment fraud against the state oil company	Did not exist	The state oil company was defrauded of K700m after attackers hijacked email from its Mozambican fuel-handling contractor and supplied false banking details, the company instructing its bank on 29 April 2026 to wire US\$403,605 to a fraudulent account; the fraud surfaced two weeks later when the genuine contractor demanded payment, and was confirmed publicly on 24 August 2026. The company attributed the control weaknesses to the government-to-government fuel procurement model being introduced before operational and cybersecurity procedures were in place, and says it is auditing payment-verification controls following a return to open tender	REGRESSED
World Bank cybersecurity and data-protection technical assistance	The foundations project's technical assistance ended with that project's closure in October 2024; no successor cybersecurity assistance appears in the base at 2025-08-01	A delegation team leader outlined technical assistance and capacity building covering critical-infrastructure security, legal and regulatory frameworks, data-protection systems and regional cybersecurity capability; no amount, financing instrument, duration or workplan is stated	ADVANCED
Chinese safe-city surveillance package offer	Malawi is the only one of the five countries studied - with Nigeria, Ghana, Morocco and Zambia - to have rejected the safe-city surveillance package offered by Chinese companies	Unchanged; the base holds no later statement, and no account of who rejected it, when, or on what grounds	NO CHANGE
Malawi Computer Emergency Response Team	The base carries no statement of the team's existence, mandate or activity at 2025-08-01	Operating within the regulator, which states an intention to establish it, alongside the data protection authority, as an independent institution with World Bank technical assistance; no establishing instrument, timetable, budget, staffing or incident statistics are held	BASELINE NOT HELD

The largest infrastructure movement of the period was procurement rather than construction. In March 2026 the regulator was advancing procurement for more than 90 towers, against a requirement of more than 1,000 cited at the same meeting, and its Director General stated that universal service fund resources remain insufficient ([procurement briefing](#)). The tower line does not appear in the project's own appraisal document ([appraisal document](#)) — a divergence between appraised design and delivered activity the base cannot document.

Regulatory enforcement began where it had not existed. The tariff-notice requirement carried no record of enforcement at the start of the period; in July 2026 the regulator found both mobile operators in breach and ordered compensation ([regulator order](#)). No proposal for a new operator licensing round existed a year ago, and by 24 July 2026 the President had authorised the ministry to identify an investor ([parliamentary account](#)).

Satellite connectivity went from an enabling capability to a deployment: at the start of the period the base recorded only that technical assistance had prepared the regulator to enable low-earth-orbit services, and by June 2026 30 rural schools were connected ([company announcement](#)).

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Customs IT connectivity arrangement with South Africa	Legal basis only: a customs mutual administrative assistance agreement negotiated in 2019 on a 2010 memorandum of cooperation, with customs information exchanged manually	An arrangement signed establishing a secure electronic platform for real-time customs data exchange, aligned to the World Customs Organisation data model, with both authorities agreeing to fast-track implementation; no go-live date, purpose-limitation, retention or reciprocity terms published; the South African revenue service notified the updated arrangement for automatic exchange of customs information on 7 August 2026 and published a draft rule amendment with it	ADVANCED
Enterprise Service Bus	Not operationalised through 2025; the e-government department's failure to bring it into service left ministries siloed and denied online passport registration and driver's licence payments	Nothing on file establishes it operating; industry voices in January 2026 were still pressing for all ministries, departments and agencies to be onboarded	NO CHANGE
Malawi National Single Window	Launched May 2025, integrating trade-related agencies including the revenue authority and the trade ministry to streamline imports and exports	Same; no later position is held at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Blockchain-enabled Digital ID Wallet	A digital ID wallet using artificial intelligence and blockchain cited as a plan by the registration bureau's principal secretary	Built by UNDP Malawi with the UN International Computing Centre, in pilot before nationwide rollout, with credentials to extend to birth certificates, driving licences and marriage certificates; no pilot scale, rollout date or cost stated, and nothing on how the arrangement sits under the Data Protection Act 2024	ADVANCED
Electoral management devices and the electronic voter register	The voter register held electronically; the electoral commission refused an observer coalition electronic access to the roll on 2025-06-05, citing the elections statute	6,500 electoral management devices deployed for voter verification at the 2025-09-16 elections, with offline glitches reported at rural polling stations	ADVANCED, OFFLINE FAILURES RECORDED
National IDs issued to adults	12.5m registered Malawians aged 16 and over (2025-05-21)	Over 13.5m (2026-07-13); an intermediate figure of over 12.8m adult IDs was stated at 2026-01-16	ADVANCED
Nzika Wallet mobile digital ID	A digital ID wallet piloted successfully, with nationwide rollout targeted for 2026; no product name or launch month stated	Named the Nzika Wallet and announced for a September 2026 launch; it complements rather than replaces the plastic card, requires prior registration and needs no periodic renewal. It was not live at 2026-08-06, and rights advocates have flagged equal-access, rural-exclusion, cybersecurity and digital-literacy caveats	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Mandatory biometric SIM registration	Launched by the regulator with the registration bureau, authenticating against the biometric identity system, with fewer than ten SIMs per person per operator and non-compliance fines up to MWK 50,000 daily for individuals and MWK 150,000 for corporates	No completion figure, compliance rate or closure date is held; the regulator and UNDP named integration of the national identity system with SIM verification as a priority area still being explored on 2026-07-10	NO CHANGE
National Registration and Identification System	12.5m citizens enrolled, close to 100% of the eligible population aged 16 and over, linked to over 33 public and private institutions (2025-05-28)	Over 13.5m holding a national digital identity, about 99% of those aged 16 and over, with over 150,000 enrolled April to June 2026, 53% of them women	NO CHANGE
National registration service fees	Not held	Raised for national identity card replacement, electronic know-your-customer verification, civil registration and marriage services under the National Registration (Amendment) Regulations 2026, gazetted on 31 July 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Central bank banknote replacement cost	MWK 50.6bn spent replacing worn banknotes (2025 actual)	MWK 69.8bn expected in 2026, about 38% higher; an economists' association president named government levies on digital money transfers as a reason cash use persists	REGRESSED
Mobile money integration with the agricultural marketing corporation	Did not exist at 2025-08-01	Mobile money integrated into the corporation's operations so farmers are paid directly into mobile wallets and customers pay electronically for commodities across its national market and depot network; no volume, value or farmer count is held	ADVANCED
Mobile money transaction value and volume	MWK 19.5tn transacted in 2024 on 1.8bn transactions, subscribers 16.2m, merchant payments 6.9% of transactions	MWK 37.9tn in 2025, up 94%, on 2.4bn transactions (up 31.6%), subscriptions 19.9m (up 23.3%) of which 44.8% active in a 30-day window; airtime 42%, cash-in and cash-out 33.1%, merchant payments 7.7%	ADVANCED
National Payments Systems Vision and Strategy 2026-2030	Did not exist at 2025-08-01	A five-year roadmap prioritising infrastructure expansion and affordability for low-income users, cybersecurity and resilience to power and connectivity failure, regulatory modernisation, fintech innovation and regional integration; the deputy governor acknowledged persistent rural gaps	ADVANCED
Regional digital retail payments platform, Malawi-Zambia corridor	Did not exist for Malawi at 2025-08-01	The first interoperable cross-border retail payment system linking Malawi and Zambia in local currencies without foreign exchange, supervised by both central banks, with three Malawian early adopters; the clearing house published the scheme rulebook setting operational and governance rules for instant low-cost cross-border retail payments, and a gender audit and strategy to 2030 drawing on research along the corridor with Zambia	ADVANCED
UnionPay e-commerce acceptance	A Standard Bank and UnionPay collaboration since 2024, with no online acceptance on record	Online acceptance open to participating merchants, settling in local currency, US dollars or both	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Competition authority interoperability order on mobile-money e-ticketing	Order in force requiring the mobile-money operator to open its exclusive football e-ticketing platform to other providers within a year, with concurrent physical ticketing for six months and 90-day progress reports; found to breach the retail payment interoperability directive and the e-money regulations	The compliance year expired around 2026-07-16; nothing held records opening, a progress report or an enforcement step	NO CHANGE, ONE-YEAR DEADLINE PASSED WITH NOTHING ON FILE
National Switch	Operating since 2015, linking banks, mobile money platforms and ATMs, with an instant bank transfer service live on the switch from 2025-06-17, real-time to any Malawian bank up to MWK 500m by short code	Same rails; an aggregator added small-business tools including interfaces, e-commerce plugins and payment links	NO CHANGE
National e-Payment Gateway	No position held at 2025-08-01	Designed as the single entry point for all government collections, supported by a financial inclusion project and the World Bank, and described as a breakthrough in 2025 despite integration hurdles; no live date, transaction figure or agency coverage stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Birth Registration Campaign	Did not exist; birth registration ran under the National Registration Act with no dedicated campaign on record	Seven phases across 25 districts using government primary schools as registration centres, targeting about 4.6m unregistered children; MWK 17.8bn required, MWK 5.4bn allocated in FY2025/26 for phases 1 and 2, MWK 12.4bn outstanding	ADVANCED
Rental income tax property registration drive	Did not exist; announced February 2026, starting in the three main cities with data collectors recruited	About 8,000 landlords registered for rental income tax, with property-registration exercises running across low- and high-density areas	ADVANCED
Land Information Management System	A web-based system live since February 2024 linking lands, surveys and physical planning, allowing parcel viewing, document submission, notifications and payment of ground rent and application fees; the scope of remaining manual transactions is not published	The ministry reviewing electronic workflows and designing digital procedures for transactions still on paper; which transactions remain manual, when revised workflows will be implemented and current processing times all remain unpublished	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Addressing System Project	A regulator-coordinated multi-stakeholder programme to give every property a physical address, spanning a national postcode system, addressing standards, an address database, physical infrastructure and geographic information systems; no completion date, no delivery figure	Same; nothing dated after 2024-02-12 is held, so the position is carried forward rather than re-established	NO CHANGE

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Automated human resource and payroll management platform	Did not exist; no government human-resource or payroll system appears in the base at 2025-08-01	In pilot before rollout across all ministries, departments, agencies, Parliament, the Judiciary and local councils; no supplier, cost, pilot scale or rollout date is stated, and nothing is stated on how personnel and payroll data is handled under the Data Protection Act 2024	ADVANCED
Electronic Invoicing System	Established by the Commissioner General under the amended value added tax statute and announced by public notice on 2025-07-31, with migration off electronic fiscal devices required from 2025-08-02; no registered base published	Regulations published 2026-01-09, the transition period ended 2026-01-31 after which prior-device invoices no longer support input tax claims, and full enforcement with penalties from 2026-05-01 after the authority rescheduled the rollout	ADVANCED, ENFORCEMENT RESCHEDULED
Public Sector Reforms Information Management System	Did not exist at 2025-08-01	Launched as a dedicated platform tracking how ministries, departments and agencies perform against reform targets; no user, coverage or output figure held	ADVANCED
Taxpayers registered on the Electronic Invoicing System	None published at 2025-08-01	About 7,500 of roughly 9,000 registered VAT operators migrated (2026-06-03), rising to 8,552 taxpayers registered (2026-07-20)	ADVANCED
Health Management Information System	In operation but weakly used: 70% of facility respondents used the system's data against 33.3% of district respondents, 31.4% of facility staff had had no data-handling training in 24 months, supervisory visits reached under half of facilities, and there were no standard operating procedures for data management	Same; nothing later is held, so the position is carried forward rather than re-established	NO CHANGE
Crime Management System	No position held at 2025-08-01	A centralised digital platform covering the case cycle from report to final disposal, with officers trained as early adopters ahead of a nationwide rollout; no procurement value, named supplier, rollout date or statement of how case-file personal data is handled under the Data Protection Act 2024	BASELINE NOT HELD
Revenue collected through the Electronic Invoicing System	No figure held at 2025-08-01	Over US\$1.2m a day, with May 2026 collections above US\$28m	BASELINE NOT HELD

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Malawi National Electronic Procurement System	Phase 1 of an e-procurement system built under the foundations project, with the procurement authority running electronic procurement under a results-based programme; use not mandatory	Mandatory nationwide from 2026-04-01 under a March 2026 government directive covering all public entities, with remote submission and registration	ADVANCED
New passport issuance system	A US\$29.9m contract awarded in January 2025; transition troubled and a backlog of over 100,000 applications	Printing resumed at Mangochi; a member told the House that applicants who filed nine months to a year earlier are being overtaken by same-day issuances, holding over 30 unfulfilled receipts	ADVANCED, PRINTING CAPACITY RESTORED
Passport queue transparency and tracking features	Did not exist; passport registration was not available online, with services siloed behind a non-operational service bus	A sequence number assigned at application and payment accepted in principle by the homeland security minister and referred to the e-government programme, with SMS notification, an online portal and messaging integration stated to follow once the new passport system stabilises; no implementation date, cost or instrument stated	ADVANCED, ANNOUNCED ONLY
Electronic Auctions Platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	A web-based system being scoped to replace paper government auctions, carrying electronic bid submission, automated bid ranking, bidder anonymity and digital publication of results	Baseline not held

Identity coverage advanced steadily and its governing statute did not. Adult holdings rose from 12.5 million in May 2025 to more than 13.5 million ([registration bureau](#)), and the mobile credential moved from a successfully piloted wallet with no name or launch month to a named product scheduled for September 2026 ([registration bureau](#)). Birth registration went the other way: a dedicated campaign did not exist a year ago and now runs across seven phases in 25 districts, but of the MWK 17.8bn required only MWK 5.4bn was allocated ([ministerial figures](#)).

Public procurement is the period's cleanest advance, moving from a system built but not required of public entities to electronic-only for all of them from 1 April 2026 ([procurement authority](#)). No post-mandate uptake figure or tender count has been published.

Data exchange advanced in use and not in rules. The exchange platform went from delivered to in use by the revenue authority and the registration bureau, with 25 e-services being onboarded ([e-government department](#)), while the service bus that would carry government-wide exchange remained unoperationalised. The ICT minister's June 2026 account — that institutions still share citizen data by email, USB drive and paper, and that a binding regulation is the missing piece — is the clearest statement of the distance between the two ([ministry account](#)).

Payments grew fast on one measure and not on the one that matters for displacing cash: transaction value rose 94% to MWK 37.9tn, while merchant payments moved only from 6.9% to 7.7% of transactions ([central bank report](#)).

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Blantyre City Council digital revenue collection	Did not exist at 2025-08-01	The council partnered a commercial bank to digitise revenue and tax collection and let residents pay for council services electronically, under the acceleration project; the council plans to introduce the systems, and no go-live date or collection figure is held	ADVANCED
Constituency Development Fund real-time dashboard	Did not exist at 2025-08-01	A public real-time platform for tracking constituency project implementation and fund spending nationally, launched by the local government ministry (Minister Ben Phiri, 2026-07-31), which states it carries project progress, budgets and locations for more than 2,000 development projects and asks citizens to raise concerns about council implementation through channels on the platform; the Minister of Lands told Parliament on 2026-08-03 that citizens would get real-time data on project status, spending patterns and contractor performance; the launching minister named the President, the Minister of Finance, the Minister of Information and the Office of the President and Cabinet as having real-time access; the same minister stated the platform's currency depends on councils uploading project information manually, warning there would be no excuse for late uploading; no platform address is established in anything held, so none of it can be inspected from the wiki	ADVANCED
Councils receiving clean audit opinions	22 councils in 2023/24	18 councils in 2024/25, with one district council receiving an adverse opinion	REGRESSED
Governance to Enable Service Delivery Project 2.0	The predecessor project running across 28 councils; no successor approved	An SDR 58.2m grant, about US\$80m equivalent, board-approved 2026-04-24, signed 2026-06-19 and ratified 2026-07-29, closing 2031-06-30, covering 32 councils with four entering for the first time; a US\$12.8m subcomponent funds business-process re-engineering, software and hardware assessments and a performance dashboard	ADVANCED
Local Authorities ICT Policy and ICT standards	Did not exist; councils operated with no framework beyond the 2023 national digitalisation policy, a 2022 situational analysis having found weak ICT support, absent council projects and ICT excluded from procurement	The first dedicated local-authority ICT policy plus ICT standards validated, with the local government finance committee and the e-government department sensitising councils to prepare for implementation and adoption; no adoption date held	ADVANCED
Local Authority Performance Assessment	In use setting performance-based-grant eligibility for district councils	2025/26 results announced, with improvement in the annual score a project development objective indicator under the successor project; 27 of 28 district councils qualified for performance-based grants	NO CHANGE

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
University AI fertigation facility, Thyolo	Did not exist at 2025-08-01	The Malawi University of Science and Technology commissioned an AI-powered fertigation system automating irrigation and fertiliser application from real-time crop-growth data at its Thyolo campus, with an AI-assisted smart tree nursery, under a continental agricultural-universities programme	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Agricultural Data Infrastructure	A multi-stakeholder dialogue on national data infrastructure for climate decision-making held in Malawi in September 2023, drawing conclusions on digitising paper records, standardising collection and embedding interoperability; nothing built	Farmers across 14 districts still use non-interoperable platforms - the meteorological department's, an agricultural NGO's, the government farm input subsidy programme's and a commodity exchange's - logging into each separately; the harmonising framework remains a proposal and a farmer-ID layer on the national register remains an argument, not a system	NO CHANGE

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
UNESCO AI Readiness Assessment report	Did not exist; the six-country regional pilot under which it was produced began in 2025	Assessment complete and validated, intended to guide the national AI strategy, with findings including gaps in policy, infrastructure, institutional capacity and education readiness, and 27.7% of the population online against household computer ownership of 4.2%	ADVANCED
Defence force cooperation with China on military AI and cybersecurity	The base carries no statement of a defence-force position on artificial intelligence or of the technology content of the China defence relationship	The defence force intends to adopt artificial intelligence in military operations and to learn it from the Chinese army, in a relationship stated to extend past exchanges into specialised training, equipment supply and institutional development, with further equipment, capacity building and command-level training under discussion	BASELINE NOT HELD

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Bank of Malawi and ICT Association Innovation Jam	An annual jam run under a six-year bank and association partnership, but no memorandum is on file before 2025-08-01	A three-year memorandum committing the bank to mentorship, incubation and technical support for innovators emerging from the annual event, with MWK 75,500,000 given to the 2025 edition held 19-22 November on an artificial-intelligence theme	ADVANCED
ICT services exports	No figure held at 2025-08-01	Rose from about US\$70m in 2020 to US\$154m in 2023, cited by a private-sector managing director as evidence that ICT already earns foreign currency	BASELINE NOT HELD

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
PayChangu	Operating as a Lilongwe-based payment aggregator founded 2021, connecting mobile money, cards and bank transfers through a single integration	Same position, with small-business tools stated as interfaces, e-commerce plugins, payment links, invoicing and analytics	NO CHANGE
University innovation lab	An active UNDP grant of US\$1,880,499 committed 2019 to equip the business and applied sciences university's innovation hub for ideation, prototyping, mentorship and incubation	Same position; no dated update since the 2019 record, with the scheduled end year falling in 2026 and no closure or extension on file	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Unlocking Talent e-learning programme	Already closed; a grant of EUR 12,996,804 committed 2019 for tablet-based learning centres in primary schools and teacher training colleges	Same position; no successor programme, evaluation or continuation is held	NO CHANGE

Malawi's artificial intelligence position was created inside this period and consists entirely of process. Nothing existed a year ago; consultative workshops began in September 2025, a draft strategy entered validation in February 2026, and a readiness assessment was validated on 22 July 2026 to guide it ([validation account](#)). No text has been adopted or published, and the assessment sits with the education ministry rather than the ICT ministry that owns the strategy.

Two rules arrived ahead of the strategy that would frame them. A statutory copyright body decided it will not register wholly AI-generated works, on a date the base cannot establish. And the Defence Minister stated in July 2026 that the defence force intends to adopt artificial intelligence in military operations and learn it from the Chinese army, a subject on which no Malawian doctrine, oversight body or budget line exists.

The sector's financing position also moved from nothing to a proposal: a four-year US\$180m roadmap presented in China in June 2026, with funding structure and timeline not made public ([ministry account](#)).

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Airtel Nzeru Connect school programme	Running as Malawi's part of a corporate foundation and UNICEF partnership begun in 2021; the base holds no Malawi-specific school count before 2025-08-01	36 schools connected with a further nine scheduled in 2026, ICT laboratories equipped with smart televisions and tablets, 12 local e-learning sites zero-rated, and more than 32,000 learners and over 900 teachers benefiting directly	ADVANCED
Airtel Nzeru Fund STEM scholarships	Did not exist	A corporate foundation funds 25 undergraduates from low-income households at the science and technology university, covering tuition, stipend, accommodation, data and a portable Wi-Fi device; the first 25 beneficiaries were named on 18 August 2026, drawn from 17 districts and taking eight programmes including computer systems, cyber security, sustainable energy engineering and metallurgy	ADVANCED
Data Protection Authority operationalisation consultancy	Did not exist; the base carries no tender, appointment or design work for the authority's structure before 2025-08-01	A World Bank-financed consultancy tendered under the acceleration project to design the authority's organisational structure, governance framework, roles and competencies; no award, consultant or completion date is on file at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED
Digital skills trained under the foundations project	Over 19,000 young people, 10,000 of them female, trained in digital skills through 10 technology hubs over 2017 to 2024	Unchanged; no successor training count is published, and the acceleration project's own training indicators are not reported in the base	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AI and Digital Solutions Lab	Not held	A second edition run in Mzuzu training 24 entrepreneurs from Nkhosakota, Rumphi, Karonga and Mzuzu in artificial-intelligence and digital tools for marketing, customer engagement and financial management, under German development cooperation and European Union programmes on young businesses and rural employment	BASELINE NOT HELD

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Internet penetration	Around 24 users per 100 inhabitants against an Eastern and Southern Africa regional average of 28 (appraisal, on a 2022 baseline); a separate 2024 account puts internet access at about 20% of citizens	80% of Malawians offline despite 87% 4G population coverage, on an industry-association report (2026-08); no state measurement is held, against a presidential target of 80% internet usage by 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
School internet connectivity	No national school-connectivity measure before 2025-08-01; the nearest earlier statement is that over 83,000 students across 81 higher-education institutions gained cheaper connectivity through the research network	85% of Malawi's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none at all, with lack of electricity and devices named as the main barriers; the World Bank is separately supporting connection of over 200 schools	BASELINE NOT HELD
Universal Service Fund	The base carries no statement of the fund's size, income, disbursement or projects before 2025-08-01	In operation and funded from the regulator's annual budget allocation, but the Director General stated that existing funding levels remain insufficient to meet the country's connectivity needs; a school connectivity project providing computer equipment runs under the fund, and secondary-school digital-skills work is stated to draw on it. No income, balance or disbursement figure is held for any year. The regulator said on 2026-08-21 that it is evaluating Universal Service Fund mechanisms to subsidise consumer devices and to fund digital-literacy work, including a proposed one-tablet-one-student programme.	BASELINE NOT HELD

Measurement did not keep pace: no measured internet-penetration figure exists for any date in the period. The most recent value the wiki holds remains around 24 users per 100 inhabitants from a May 2024 appraisal ([appraisal document](#)), while a presidential directive of February 2026 set a target of 80% internet usage by 2026 with no baseline attached.

School connectivity was measured for the first time: 85% of Malawi's 9,000 schools have limited or no internet access and about 900 have none ([landscape analysis](#)).

Council performance moved backwards on the one audited measure available: clean audit opinions fell to 18 in 2024/25 from 22 the year before, announced alongside the launch of a public spending dashboard ([launch account](#)).

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National Payments System Report series	Quarterly and annual series in publication, with the 2024 annual report reported 2025-04-16	Series continuing, with a Q2 2025 report reported 2025-11-18 and the 2025 annual report published 2026-03-30	NO CHANGE
Fourth National ICT Survey	BASELINE NOT HELD	In the field across all districts, including the refugee camp at Dzaleka, covering 12,000 households on mobile and computer ownership, internet access, digital financial services, e-commerce and cybersecurity awareness, with the recruitment of its field staff publicly questioned	Baseline not held

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Malawi Low Resource Language Data Trust	Did not exist; no Chichewa language dataset or data trust is on record	A government initiative assembling licensed Chichewa language content as artificial-intelligence training data and developing core frameworks, supported by the World Bank and the Gates Foundation; no dataset, licence terms, governance structure or release is published	ADVANCED
Machine-readable access to the electronic voter register	The electoral commission had refused an observer coalition's request for analysable electronic copies of the 2025 and prior voter rolls, holding that the elections statute limits inspection to verification of entries at registration centres and regional offices	The same position stands; nothing held records a later request, appeal or change of practice, including after the 2025-09-16 elections	NO CHANGE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Grid supply and reliability as it constrains telecom sites and data centres	A utility annual report or energy regulator sector statistics giving generation capacity, delivered energy, outage duration and the industrial tariff; nothing in the wiki is tagged to this subject for Malawi at any date	not yet probed
Delivered IT load of the national and commercial data centres	An acceleration-project procurement or supervision document, or an operator data-sheet, stating design and delivered critical load and backup generation	not yet probed
Electrification programme for the roughly 900 schools with no connectivity	A Ministry of Education or Ministry of Energy programme document, or the 2026/27 budget detail, naming a school-electrification line with a school count and appropriation	not yet probed
Off-grid and solar powering of rural base stations under the tower programme	The regulator's tower procurement tender documents, which would state the power specification for the more than 90 sites	not yet probed
Malawi Internet Exchange Point	A regulator or Internet Society record of the exchange's members, peak traffic and peering ratio; the base holds a 3% local-content figure but nothing on the interconnection layer that would explain it	not yet probed
Government cloud or shared hosting service for ministries and agencies	An e-government department service catalogue or project component report stating what the national data centre actually offers agencies and on what terms	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Engineering and operations staffing of the regulator, the response team and the e-government department	An establishment table or annual report giving approved and filled technical posts	not yet probed
National cybersecurity strategy or policy	A published Malawi national cybersecurity strategy, or a Ministry of ICT statement confirming none exists; the base holds cybersecurity only as a component of other instruments	not yet probed
Electronic Transactions and Cyber Security Act 2016 and its enforcement record	The Act as gazetted plus any prosecution or enforcement statistics; the base cites the Communications Act 2016 repeatedly but holds nothing on Malawi's cybercrime statute	not yet probed
Incidents handled by the computer emergency response team	A response team or regulator annual report giving incidents reported and resolved by year	not yet probed
Critical information infrastructure designation	A statutory instrument or regulator notice designating critical information infrastructure and the obligations attaching to it; named as a World Bank assistance area in March 2026 with no instrument on file	not yet probed
National fibre backbone route length and operating status	A regulator sector report or ICT ministry statement giving fibre kilometres in service and the operator, against roughly US\$140m of Chinese lending committed across two phases	not yet probed
Mobile and internet subscriber and coverage series	A regulator quarterly or annual sector statistics report giving subscribers, penetration and population coverage by technology; the base has no regulator-published series for Malawi at all	not yet probed
International capacity and submarine cable landing arrangements	A record of Malawi's transit arrangements through Mozambique, Tanzania or Zambia and the cable systems they reach; Malawi is landlocked and the base says nothing about how its traffic leaves the country	not yet probed
Data localisation or residency requirement	The Data Protection Act's cross-border transfer provisions or an implementing regulation; sovereignty is the stated rationale for local hosting throughout, with no legal requirement identified	not yet probed
Death registration coverage	A registration bureau figure for deaths registered after 2025; the last held figure is under 200,000 stated at 2025-05-28 against over 3.5m births registered	not yet probed
Business and company registration system	A Registrar General statement or e-government service listing establishing whether business registration is live on the national platform; it is named only as a target in the vendor portal proposal	not yet probed
Customary land registration under the Customary Land Act 2016	A lands ministry figure for customary estates registered and district land registries operating; the only source held is a 2020 donor programme reflection reporting three district registries	not yet probed
Driver's licence online renewal	A road traffic directorate or national platform service listing; it is named as a presidential directive target and an industry association ask, with no delivery record	not yet probed
Education Management Information System	A Ministry of Education statistical bulletin or system description; the only education source held is a 2024 rapid scan, which is landscape framing and carries no system position	not yet probed
Central bank digital currency proof of concept	The National Payments Systems Vision and Strategy document itself; the held press account of the launch names no such work, and the wiki holds no central bank publication	not yet probed
National earth-observation or satellite data programme	Any dated statement from the surveys department, the meteorological department or the regulator naming a satellite data holding, ground station or earth-observation data-sharing arrangement; the base holds zero Malawi sources on this subject	not yet probed
National Statistical Office release programme	The office's published release calendar, or the census and integrated household survey report pages; no statistical office output at all is held for Malawi	not yet probed
Financial inclusion consumer survey, next round	A survey round later than the 2023 edition published August 2024; the base holds no successor and no announced fieldwork date	not yet probed
Government Notice 40 of 2024, commencement of the Data Protection Act	The gazette text, which would settle whether commencement was 2 or 3 June 2024 and therefore when the general exemption elapsed	not yet probed
Access to Information Act 2017	The Act's text, the information commission's annual report, or any request-and-response record; the base names the Act once, in a 2022 essay, and holds nothing on whether it operates	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Statistics Act 2013	The Act's text or a statistical office statement; named once in a 2022 essay, with no position held on the statistical system's legal basis or its interaction with the Data Protection Act	not yet probed
Enforcement under the Data Protection Act 2024	A regulator enforcement register, annual report or published determination; no fine, order, breach notification, complaint or prosecution under the Act appears in anything held, more than two years after commencement	not yet probed
Regulator misinformation and disinformation tracking system	A regulator notice or procurement record establishing when the system was introduced, its legal basis and its data-handling terms; the base has only a newspaper year-review reporting its introduction in 2025	not yet probed
Lilongwe Declaration on Collaborative Regulation, text	The regional regulators' association publication of the Declaration, unpublished at 2026-08-05, so a named-analyst commentary is the whole of the wiki's account and the seven action areas are nowhere enumerated	not yet probed
Ratification or transposition of AU or SADC data instruments	An instrument of ratification for the AU Malabo Convention, or a Malawian instrument transposing the AU Data Policy Framework or a regional model law; the base records only that the Data Protection Act aligns closely with the continental framework, in a third-party legal review	not yet probed
Public and parliamentary contestation of Malawi's data governance	Hansard for the sittings at which the Data Protection Act and the financing bills were debated; the base holds only two sources on this subject for Malawi, one of them a paywalled lede	not yet probed
EU-Malawi digital and data governance cooperation	Any EU-Malawi instrument text or Delegation statement addressing data governance; no Malawi source in the base carries this tag at all, and the EU material held is tagged to identity and registry subjects and says nothing about data-governance alignment or adequacy	not yet probed
United States-Malawi technology cooperation	A signed cooperation agreement, an embassy or State Department announcement, or a development finance or aid agency digital programme record naming Malawi; the base holds no United States-specific technology item for Malawi	not yet probed
Current position on the Chinese safe-city surveillance package	A government or regulator statement, or a procurement record, showing whether the 2023 rejection still stands	not yet probed
India-Malawi technology cooperation	A bilateral memorandum, Indian line-of-credit record or e-network programme document naming Malawi; nothing is held	not yet probed
Gulf state technology investment in Malawi	An investment agreement, sovereign-fund announcement or ministry statement naming a UAE, Saudi or Qatari counterparty; nothing is held	not yet probed
Adopted National AI Strategy, text and adoption instrument	The gazetted or Cabinet-approved strategy document, or a Ministry of ICT publication recording its adoption date	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence governance institution	A founding instrument or ministerial statement naming the body, its mandate and its budget line	not yet probed
Copyright society directive on AI-generated works	The body's own statement, circular or board minute stating the rule, its effective date and its test for wholly AI-generated	not yet probed
Military artificial intelligence doctrine, oversight or procurement record	A defence ministry policy, a parliamentary defence-committee record, or a procurement register entry for the defence-force training pipeline	not yet probed
ICT sector share of GDP and sector employment	A statistical office national-accounts release or a regulator sector report giving ICT value added and employment, dated	not yet probed
Official ICT services export series after 2023	A central bank balance-of-payments services table or statistical office trade-in-services release for 2024 or later	not yet probed
Count of licensed technology firms and data centre operators	A regulator licence register or Registrar General extract listing ICT operators, dated	not yet probed
Startup Act or innovation legislation	A bill, act or Cabinet paper establishing a startup registration or incentive regime; nothing of the kind is held for Malawi	not yet probed
National innovation or venture fund	A fund instrument or budget line naming a state-backed innovation or venture facility, with capitalisation and dates	not yet probed
Technology hubs and incubators operating in Malawi	A directory or survey naming the hubs, their operators and their status; the base holds only one university innovation lab and one university facility	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Startup funding raised, deals or jobs created	A deal-tracker dataset or an association report giving dated, per-year totals for Malawian startups	not yet probed
Malawi national budget documents	The 2025/26 and 2026/27 Approved Estimates of Expenditure on Recurrent and Capital Budget, or the Budget Statement itself; there is no domestic budget archive for Malawi, so every appropriation figure held is a journalist's or minister's reading	not yet probed
Universal Service Fund accounts	A regulator annual report or fund financial statement giving levy income, balance and project disbursement; the only statement held is the Director General's remark that funding is insufficient	not yet probed
Domestic state financing of digital transformation	A Ministry of Information and Digitalization vote in the Approved Estimates; the hub's financing block records the domestic-state series as pending, so all tracked deals are external	not yet probed
The Malawi-vendor signed instrument	A signed memorandum or framework agreement; only the ministry's account of a June 2026 meeting is held, with funding structure and timeline expressly not made public	not yet probed
National digital literacy measure or programme	A statistical office or regulator household ICT-access survey reporting digital skills, or a costed national digital literacy strategy; the wiki holds zero Malawi sources on this subject	not yet probed
National research capacity in digital technologies	A named research centre's funding line or publication record beyond the two university facilities held; no national digital research programme appears in the base	not yet probed
Acceleration project training and skills results	A project implementation status and results report against the results framework; the base holds only the appraisal targets and no reported achievement	not yet probed
Retail data and device affordability	A regulator-published tariff schedule or an affordability series; the base holds the appraisal's statement that 2GB costs almost 10% of annual gross national income per head, and nothing dated since	not yet probed
Rural-urban and gender divide in internet use	A disaggregated national ICT household survey; the base carries a mobile-money gender gap of 9.7 percentage points for 2025 and rural agent activity rates, but no internet-use split of any kind	not yet probed
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or a Malawian government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

Three subjects carry no Malawian source at any date: energy supply to networks and data centres, national technical capacity, and digital literacy. Their absence is not a thin reading of a sparse record but an empty one.

The recurring structural gap is that the communications regulator publishes nothing the wiki holds — no sector statistics, no subscriber or coverage series, no fee schedule, no universal service fund accounts. Every regulatory figure in this report therefore arrives through journalism or a ministerial statement, and on the size of the spectrum fee cut those two give different answers ([regulator announcement](#); [parliamentary account](#)). There is also no domestic budget archive for Malawi, so no appropriation figure here rests on a budget document.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-26
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/MWI/MWI-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/MWI/MWI-progress-2026-08-26.pdf
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.